Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names

Centre Number	Candidate Number

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/31

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

You must have:
Sources/Interpretations Booklet (enclosed)

Total Marks
56

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two sections in this question paper. Answer Questions 1 and 2 from **Section A**. From **Section B**, answer Questions 3(a) to 3(d).
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided — *there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this paper is 56.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets — *use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.*
- The marks available for spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology are clearly indicated.

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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SECTION A

Answer both questions.
Study Source A below and then answer Question 1.

Source A

Source A: From a speech to the Weimar National Assembly by Hugo Preuss, head of the Constitutional Commission, July 1919.

"I have often listened to the constitutional debates with real concern, looking at the gentlemen of the Right and fearing they might say: 'Do you hope to give a parliamentary system to a nation like this, which resists it with every sinew in its body?' One finds suspicion everywhere; Germans cannot shake off their old political timidity and their submissive deference to the authoritarian state."

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1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the new Weimar Constitution. **(4)**

Complete the table below to explain your answer.

(i) What I can infer:

.....

.....

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Details in the source that tell me this:

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.....

.....

(ii) What I can infer:

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Details in the source that tell me this:

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(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

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2 Explain why the Weimar Republic faced significant political instability in the years 1919–23. **(12)**

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- The Treaty of Versailles
- The Kapp Putsch

You **must** also use information of your own.

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(Question 2 continued)

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(Question 2 continued)

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION A = 16 MARKS

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SECTION B

For Question 3, refer to the Sources/Interpretations Booklet.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet. **(8)**

How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into The persecution of disabled people in Nazi Germany in the years 1933–39?

Explain your answer, using Sources B and C and your knowledge of the historical context.

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(Question 3(a) continued)

(Total for Question 3(a) = 8 marks)

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(b) Study **Interpretations 1 and 2** in the Sources/Interpretations Booklet. **(4)**

They give different views about The persecution of disabled people in Nazi Germany in the years 1933–39.

What is the main difference between the views?

Explain your answer, using details and information from both interpretations.

(Total for Question 3(b) = 4 marks)

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(c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about The persecution of disabled people in Nazi Germany in the years 1933–39. **(4)**

You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

(Total for Question 3(c) = 4 marks)

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(d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about The persecution of disabled people in Nazi Germany in the years 1933–39? **(16)**

Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

Spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology will be assessed in this question.

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(Question 3(d) continued)

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(Question 3(d) continued)

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(Question 3(d) continued)

(Total for spelling, punctuation, grammar and use of specialist terminology = 4 marks)
(Total for Question 3(d) = 20 marks)

TOTAL FOR SECTION B = 36 MARKS

TOTAL FOR PAPER = 52 MARKS (+4 marks for SPaG)

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Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

From a secret report written by a local public health official in Saxony, December 1935.

"The implementation of the Law for the Prevention of Hereditarily Diseased Offspring is proceeding smoothly, though we must confront lingering traditional prejudices. In this district, we have processed over eighty applications for compulsory sterilisation this year alone. While some families initially protest out of ignorance, the majority are brought to understand that eliminating hereditary defects is a biological duty to the state. The local courts have been highly cooperative, accepting medical recommendations without delay. However, we require more secure facilities to prevent patients from fleeing before the surgical procedures are completed."

Source C

An official Nazi propaganda poster, published by the Office of Racial Policy in 1938. The German text translates to: "60,000 Reichsmarks is what this person suffering from a hereditary defect costs the People's community during his lifetime. Fellow citizen, that is your money too."



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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

From The Nazi State and Society by Dr. Julian Kroll, published in 1998.

"The persecution of minorities and disabled people under the Nazi regime was fundamentally driven by a deeply ingrained biological and racial ideology. From the moment they seized power, the Nazis utilized the legal system and public health networks to implement eugenics policies. The German medical profession was highly complicit, willingly submitting thousands of patients for compulsory sterilisation. The general public largely conformed to these measures because they had been thoroughly indoctrinated by racial hygiene propaganda in schools and media. This pseudoscience convinced ordinary citizens that sterilising the disabled was essential to protect the purity of the Aryan gene pool."

Interpretation 2

From The Economics of Terror by Professor Arthur Kitson, published in 2004.

"While racial rhetoric was always present, the driving force behind the escalating persecution of disabled people was economic utility. During the Great Depression, the Nazi state sought to justify its welfare cuts by portraying the vulnerable as a parasitic financial burden on the hard-working taxpayer. Propaganda deliberately targeted the cost of care to build resentment among workers who were themselves enduring long hours and low wages. Active resistance to these policies was minimal because the police state successfully silenced dissent. However, when the regime transitioned from sterilisation to the secret T4 euthanasia programme, public alarm grew, showing that conformity relied on keeping the ultimate fate of these victims hidden from their families."

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